Last season, he was playing youth football.

Today, he scores in Serie A.

Could data have spotted him one year earlier?

Theo Grasso · Football Data Analyst

Data: SofaScore

THE CHALLENGE

Rank every young Italian in Primavera 1

Italian players born between 2006 and 2009, 2025/26 season, statistics only.

248 players ranked

4 positions

810+ minutes played

Theo Grasso · Football Data Analyst

Data: SofaScore

THE METHOD

One score out of 100 per position

Goalkeepers

Save % 45 · Distribution and safety 40

Defenders

Defending 55 · Build-up 30

Midfielders

Passing 31 · Creativity 31 · Ball winning 23

Forwards

Finishing 50 · Creativity 15 · Dribbling 12 · Duels 8

> Every position: 15% playing time. Every player compared with the whole Primavera 1.

Theo Grasso · Football Data Analyst

Data: SofaScore

GOALKEEPERS

Top 3

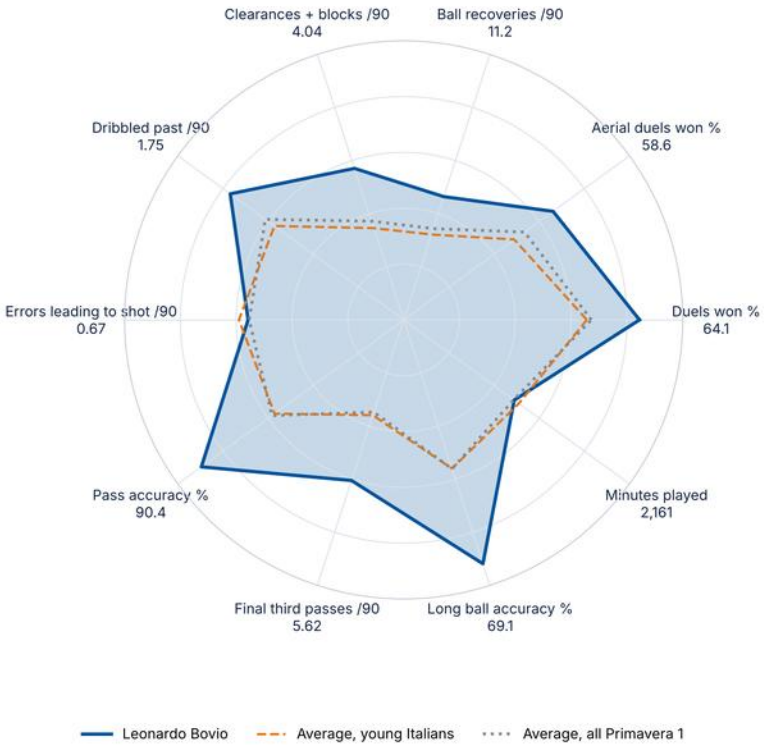
RANK	PLAYER	SCORE / 100
1	**Niccolo Fontana** Cesena U20 · born 2007	**81.0**
2	**Andrea Vailati** Monza U20 · born 2007	**80.4**
3	**Alessandro Anelli** Atalanta U20 · born 2008	**77.4**



DEFENDERS

Top 3

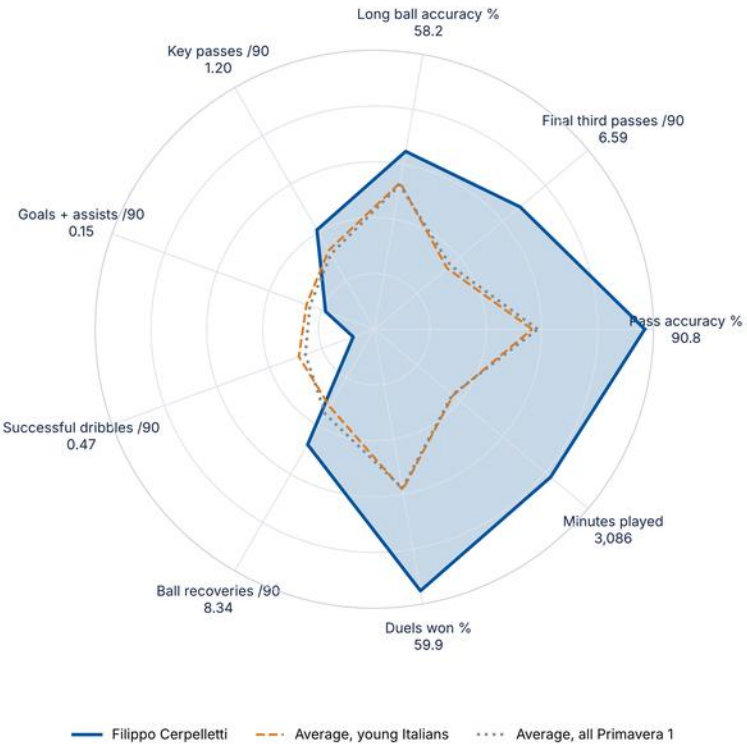
RANK	PLAYER	SCORE / 100
1	**Leonardo Bovio** Inter U20 · born 2008	83.3
2	**Edoardo Sadotti** Fiorentina U20 · born 2006	78.6
3	**Dario Pelosi** Frosinone U20 · born 2006	77.3



MIDFIELDERS

Top 3

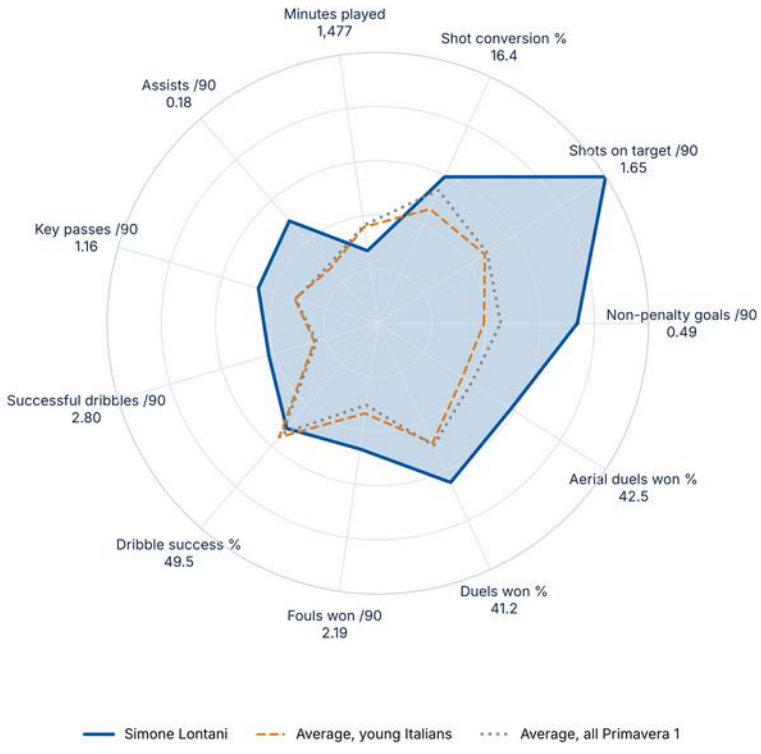
RANK	PLAYER	SCORE / 100
1	**Filippo Cerpelletti** Inter U20 · born 2007	**77.7**
2	**Marco Buonaiuto** Monza U20 · born 2007	**75.9**
3	**Filippo Bertaccini** Cesena U20 · born 2007	**75.8**



FORWARDS

And the #1 forward is...

RANK	PLAYER	SCORE / 100
1	**Simone Lontani** Milan U20 · born 2008	**83.8**
2	**Nicolò Baldo** Atalanta U20 · born 2006	**81.9**
3	**Riccardo Braschi** Fiorentina U20 · born 2006	**77.1**



THE ANSWER

Simone Lontani

#1 forward of the ranking · born 2008

2025/26 · MILAN U20

10 goals, 3 assists

1,477 minutes

#1 for shots on target /90

→

SUMMER 2026 · PARMA

Joins a Serie A club

First Serie A goal

against Monza

He is not the only one.

Riccardo Braschi
#3 forward

FC Thun, Switzerland

Edoardo Sadotti
#2 defender

Alcione Milano

Both moved to senior football in summer 2026.

Theo Grasso · Football Data Analyst

Data: SofaScore

THE VALIDATION

The data agrees with the experts

5/8 official Team of the Season players in my dataset rank in my top 16% at their position

Alessandro Anelli	Goalkeeper	**#3 of 24**
Fabio Pandolfi	Midfielder	**#7 of 117**
Filippo Galvagno	Forward	**#4 of 38**
Luca Lo Monaco	Forward	**#6 of 38**
Luca Montenegro	Midfielder	**#12 of 117**

> Revelation of the Season: Antonio Arena (Roma, born 2009), #7 of 38 forwards in my ranking.

Team of the Season: Primavera Best Awards 2025/26, Sportitalia.

THE BEST XI

Italy's next generation

Young Italians of Primavera 1, 2025/26, score out of 100

